

to another. They were earning as much as 5 to 10 per cent annually from the upfront commissions alone.'

Another veteran private banker also has fond memories of the 2003 to 2008 era: 'We were on a roll. Every three months, some mutual fund or the other used to take our sales teams to foreign locations. I personally saw at least fifteen different countries thanks to them. These trips were lavish and no expenses were spared to indulge the distribution team. This, in turn, was driving the sales behaviour.' Such lavish entertainment for mutual fund distributors is still the norm. [Exhibit 22](#) shows two such 'contests' recently hosted by manufacturers to incentivize their distributors to sell more—the more they sell, the nicer their all-expenses-paid holidays.